



AFTER

Ratification of the amendment was the final measure in ending enslavement in the United States. The way was open for the integration of the formerly enslaved into society.

DEFINING FREEDOM

The amendment guaranteed that **enslaved people would be free**, but the exact nature of that freedom was not defined. Other measures were needed. The Fourteenth Amendment, ratified in 1868, **gave men who had been enslaved U.S. citizenship**, and the Fifteenth, ratified in 1870, guaranteed their **right to vote**.

THE ONGOING DIVIDE

White opposition in the South later rolled back integration by making voter registration harder. In practice, the South's Black population would have to wait until the **Civil Rights Act of 1964** and the **Voting Rights Act of 1965**, to win effective enfranchisement.